

Religion and the History of Hip Hop Final Portfolio Project (40%)

Overview

During the first few weeks of class students will form groups of ca. 4 and design a collaborative project. As part of this project each student will also develop their own portfolio over the course of the semester and submit a final document reflective of their contributions to the group.

Expectations/ Criteria for Assessment

- 1) Every student will participate in a collaborative group project that will be presented to the class during the final weeks of the semester
- 2) Every student will submit a final project based on their own independent work, which will include:
 - a. A written/conceptual framing essay 5-6 double-spaced pages in length
 - b. A portfolio that compiles “primary sources” that document the topic of inquiry
- 3) Both the Individual Project and Group Presentation components should:
 - a. Be organized around a topic related to the intersection of Hip Hop and Religion
 - b. Include an engagement with at least three different artists/groups
 - c. Include an engagement with at least three different decades
 - d. Include an engagement with specific songs/albums
 - e. Include an engagement with the broader social world and historical context
- 4) Every Individual Project and Group Presentation should find a working definition of religion (cite a scholar; don’t make up your own) that helps to clarify how the project/presentation understands the connection(s) between Religion and Hip Hop.
Remember: the assignment is intended to force you to simultaneously think about and bring together the topics of Religion, Hip Hop and History.

Timeline

February/March: Develop Groups and Proposal Ideas in Conversation with Peers and TAs

Tuesday, March 24, 11:59 PM: Formalize proposals for group portfolios projects or individual research papers via your Discussion Sections; your project proposal is due on this date in lieu of that week’s discussion paper submission.

Wednesday, May 6: Final Individual Essay and Portfolio Due via Courseworks